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Personal Reflection – Sprint 2

During this sprint, my main focus was on researching and learning Firebase and React, two technologies I had very limited experience with at the start. After receiving feedback from our professor about improving our technical implementation, I made it a personal goal to understand these tools in depth. I spent time watching tutorials, reading documentation, and experimenting with small test projects to build a stronger foundation before contributing to our main application.

While Andrew handled most of the initial Firebase setup, I actively assisted him with integration, testing, and troubleshooting throughout the process. I reviewed the authentication flow and helped identify several issues in the sign-up and sign-in logic. My role mainly involved testing and verifying that user registration, login, and logout all worked as expected. I also double-checked the deployment configuration and confirmed that Firebase Hosting was functioning correctly once changes were made. Through this process, I gained hands-on experience in reviewing and debugging a real-world React project connected to a cloud backend.

This phase was challenging because I had to learn React component structures and Firebase's authentication logic at the same time. At first, I struggled to understand how asynchronous operations and state management worked together, which caused some confusion during testing. To overcome this, I kept notes while researching, cross-referenced documentation, and asked questions during our team discussions. The more I explored, the more I began to understand how each part of the system connects from user input in React to authentication validation in Firebase.

By the end of this sprint, I had significantly improved my technical confidence. I now understand how to manage user sessions; test React components and verify deployments in Firebase. This experience not only strengthened my coding knowledge but also taught me how valuable independent research and collaborative problem-solving can be in real development environments.

Moving forward, I plan to deepen my understanding of React hooks, improve my debugging efficiency, and start contributing more directly to the frontend logic in upcoming sprints.